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AUG. 12

The girl's parents and others file a petition in the Calcutta High Court. Sandip Ghosh resigns as principal of RGKMCH and is appointed principal of CNMCH

AUG. 13

The court transfers the case to the Central Bureau of Investigation and sends Ghosh on leave. Renovation work starts near the crime scene, sparking new controversy

AUG. 14

Thousands of people, especially women, participate in a 'Reclaim the Night' rally. Later in the night, hundreds of miscreants storm into the hospital and vandalise critical units such as the emergency and ENT departments

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AUG. 16

The High Court pulls up the police for failing to stop the ruckus and asks it to "place on record the entire sequence of events which ultimately led to the unfortunate incident". Meanwhile, CBI starts grilling Ghosh, interrogating him multiple times

AUG. 20

The Supreme Court hears the case suo motu and pulls up state administration for failing in its responsibilities. By the evening, the state government issues a notification seeking applications from former army and police officers to be employed as security officers in hospitals across Bengal

**Artist impression*

CRIMINAL BLUNDER 3

Principal resigns, is made principal elsewhere

A professor of orthopaedics, Dr Sandip Ghosh had been transferred twice in the past three years, but quickly reinstated; once within a couple of weeks and another time within hours. This time, Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee is said to have thrown her weight behind him, transferring him to another prestigious state-run hospital as principal instead of accepting his resignation before the uproar forced a reversal of that decision.

↘ Even though RGKMCH principal Sandip Ghosh tenders resignation on Aug. 12, he is transferred to Calcutta National Medical College as principal

Multiple formal complaints have been lodged against Ghosh in the past few years, one as recent as April this year. Chief among these is that Ghosh was the mastermind of a racket that involved the unlawful collection of biomedical waste from hospital vats to sell to outsiders, and that he used dead bodies sent to the hospital by the police for post-mortem for an ENT workshop without the necessary permissions and consent.

A committee had, in fact, been set up by the then RGKMCH medical superintendent and vice-principal in March 2023 to inquire into the allegations of mismanagement of biomedical waste. Its convenor was Akhtar Ali, former deputy superintendent (non-medical) of RGKMCH and now posted at the Murshidabad Medi-